



FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 44

# TEXAS

## WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

*Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — the first cross-state dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Texas's family courts and child-welfare system.*

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# 192

TEXAS FAMILIES ON RECORD · 301  
CHILDREN IMPACTED · 20 MONTHS  
MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING  
TIME

REPORT GENERATED

MAY 7, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED

62 OF 254

COMPILED BY

MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

**01 NAMED COURT ACTORS · TEXAS**

A name appears below only after 3 or more independent families have named the same actor in Texas. Submitter names, emails, and contact details are never published. Comments below are direct family reports — one per family — with all identifying information removed.

**Karl Hays**JUDGE · HAYS · **5 FAMILIES**

"The rights to my children were taken away while I was in rehab during a court session in which I was not present. I have been fighting for my day in court since 2023 to speak/see my children."

"Violation of due process, lack of jurisdiction, combining of cases, ex parte communications."

"Facts were ignored. Guardian ad litem testimony was not heard after months of investigation." **HAYS COUNTY COURT,**

"Acting out not on behalf of best interest of the child."

"Abuse and adultery are not considered."

**Monica Rawlins**JUDGE · 328TH FORT BEND COUNTY TEXAS COURT · **3 FAMILIES**

"She is up for reelection and my amicus Danny hoke contributes to her election campaign and there is a conflict of interest and they are very unfair. Have separated family and have to desire to reunify"

"She ignored evidence of my ex husband violating the temporary orders and standard orders and did not require any evidence from his attorney or the Amicus when they committed perjury against me." **FORT BEND**

"Didn't acknowledge ex wife assault" **FORT BEND**

**Public threshold rule:** Names are grouped conservatively by normalized spelling, role, and location. Common titles, punctuation, casing, and middle initials collapse together. Close misspellings are not auto-merged without admin review. Only family-direct submissions count toward the public threshold.

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

# TEXAS AT A GLANCE.

Across 192 Texas families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

|                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                   |                                                                          |                                                                                     |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>CHILDREN IMPACTED</div> <div>301</div> <div>185 of 192 families reported child counts</div> | <div>MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN</div> <div>\$163,500</div> <div>median across 88 families reporting 3+ categories</div> | <div>MEDIAN MONTHS LOST</div> <div>20</div> <div>of parenting time</div> | <div>WENT PRO SE</div> <div>49.5%</div> <div>38.0% after running out of money</div> |
| <div>SUBMISSIONS</div> <div>192</div>                                                            | <div>AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY</div> <div>1.6</div>                                                                   | <div>FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN</div> <div>185 of 192</div>             | <div>COUNTIES REPRESENTED</div> <div>62</div>                                       |

## WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Texas families — and families in every state — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com)

03 THE COST OF TEXAS FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

| EXPENSE CATEGORY                                           | RESPONSES | MEDIAN    | MEAN      | TOTAL REPORTED |
|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-----------|-----------|----------------|
| Attorney Fees                                              | 127       | \$25,000  | \$108,655 | \$13,799,175   |
| Lost Wages                                                 | 94        | \$10,000  | \$87,191  | \$8,196,000    |
| Other Court Fees                                           | 64        | \$956     | \$18,974  | \$1,214,319    |
| Therapy / Evaluations                                      | 88        | \$1,000   | \$5,384   | \$473,790      |
| Reunification Services                                     | 62        | \$150     | \$2,083   | \$129,152      |
| GAL Fees                                                   | 79        | \$2,000   | \$7,025   | \$555,000      |
| Asset Loss <sup>1</sup>                                    | 88        | \$41,500  | —         | —              |
| Median Family Burden (88 families reporting 3+ categories) | —         | \$163,500 | —         | —              |

**Median vs. mean:** Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least \$1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

**1. On asset loss:** One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median (\$41,500) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

|                           |  |       |           |
|---------------------------|--|-------|-----------|
| Median months lost        |  | 20    | 1.7 yrs   |
| Mean months lost          |  | 33    | 2.8 yrs   |
| Total across all families |  | 4,361 | 363.4 yrs |

## 04 WHO IS REPORTING · TEXAS

Most families documenting in Texas are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children.

## CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

## CASE STATUS

|                                    |  |    |     |
|------------------------------------|--|----|-----|
| Active case: stuck or delayed      |  | 77 | 40% |
| Not provided                       |  | 45 | 23% |
| Case closed: within last 2 years   |  | 33 | 17% |
| Case closed: more than 2 years ago |  | 15 | 8%  |
| Not in court but still affected    |  | 7  | 4%  |

## SYSTEM AFFECTED

|                                                    |  |    |     |
|----------------------------------------------------|--|----|-----|
| Both Family Court and CPS                          |  | 74 | 39% |
| Family Court Only                                  |  | 72 | 38% |
| Unknown                                            |  | 26 | 14% |
| CPS (Child Protective Services) Only               |  | 13 | 7%  |
| Foster Care / Termination of Parental Rights (TPR) |  | 2  | 1%  |

## DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

## TIME IN SYSTEM

|                   |  |    |     |
|-------------------|--|----|-----|
| 1 – 3 years       |  | 42 | 22% |
| 5 – 10 years      |  | 33 | 17% |
| 3 – 5 years       |  | 28 | 15% |
| 6 months – 1 year |  | 22 | 11% |
| Over 10 years     |  | 19 | 10% |

## CUSTODY STATUS

|                                   |  |    |     |
|-----------------------------------|--|----|-----|
| 50/50 Joint                       |  | 51 | 27% |
| No Contact / Total Loss of Access |  | 49 | 26% |
| Visitation Only                   |  | 47 | 24% |
| Full Custody                      |  | 16 | 8%  |
| Partial / Shared                  |  | 11 | 6%  |

## GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

## TOP COUNTIES

|            |  |    |    |
|------------|--|----|----|
| Harris     |  | 18 | 9% |
| Tarrant    |  | 15 | 8% |
| Williamson |  | 6  | 3% |
| Fort Bend  |  | 6  | 3% |
| Bexar      |  | 5  | 3% |
| Hays       |  | 5  | 3% |

## TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

|                                                                             |  |    |     |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|----|-----|
| Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)         |  | 65 | 34% |
| False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report) |  | 25 | 13% |
| High Conflict Divorce                                                       |  | 22 | 11% |
| Other: (Short answer)                                                       |  | 14 | 7%  |
| Other                                                                       |  | 12 | 6%  |

## 05 PARENT VOICES — TEXAS

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Texas comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.



*My case is an anomaly. It started out with CPS illegally taking my kids because I couldn't find my prescription medication that they knew my OBGYN prescribed me. 10 hrs after they took my babies I found my medicine bottle but they didn't care. My kids were put in foster care but [...]*

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

## ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

The 328th family court in fort bend county TX has been a complete disaster for my family. Judge Monica Rawlins is a lousy Judge that separates families and doesn't review evidence submitted to the court. I have had to pay over \$50k to an attorney to fight a false TRO and false [...]

— TEXAS PARENT · ANONYMOUS

## MORE VOICES FROM TEXAS

Ripped my family to shreds. Kids and mother traumatized. This is so much worse than being married to an abuser.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court system in Wilbar County Texas has abused my children. They're alienated for me. My oldest hates me and thinks the grandmother told them that I abandoned them. The family court system in Wilbar County Texas has abused my children. Their alienated for me. My [...]

— SHAWN

Family court fraudulent took my kids and placed them with the parent that they were initially removed from with CPS.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has destroyed me and my kids bond my family my peace of mind in my right to be a mom to my children

— ELNETTA

The family court system has caused even more trauma for my son and I, and places our abusers rights, over my child's safety. Over 6 years they have exhausted my family me, and my son, and all of our time, effort, and finances, while my son continues to be abused by his father [...]

— GRACE

It has destroyed my life. They have ripped away the only joy in my life and for no reason than my ex wanted to look like the better parent!!

— LORI

## 05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



*I lost any joy in my life at all. Everything a mother should be there for was ripped away. I have 2 sons that were married with children when this happened with my daughter so when they took her. I had nothing anymore. All over false accusations and a caseworker named Chrystal [...]*

— TERRI

Stolen my only child. Facilitated and assisted the abuser in continued abuse and neglect to myself and my child.

— HEATHER

The judge didn't listen to my children when he took them to his chambers and they told him the physical abuse they witnessed at the hand of their father he didn't listen to the things the kids had went through being mentally abused by him. He did not listen to the answers where [...]

— MIRANDA

They battered our family and used illegal covert systems to damage and exploit nakedness images of adults and children fir their satisfied leverage

— BRANDI

It has destroyed me it has caused my children pain and suffering..my baby is so confused about everything

— DESTINY

Tortured us, stolen my children's youth and our family

— CRYSTAL

This system has destroyed my life, rendered me homeless, cost me well over \$20k and counting, and has crushed my son's heart and soul. I am still in the fight. I will try to hold out as long as possible. The family court system and my ex's attorney are evil incarnate and need to [...]

— JACOB

It has empowered me to learn my rights, never question myself and never back down when I see injustice. I am my children's voice and I will not be silenced. I am going back in if you would like to follow my journey.

— M

They have helped a father punish a family for saying no to ongoing abuse they have stolen our lives, our memories and childhood dreams

— JENNIFER

## 05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



*They have stripped me of my children. Gave ex total say on everything. Awarded the abuser to continue abusing, he has no care what the cost to the children is. How can the law do this? Damaging tlchildren is beyond comprehension*

— REBECCA

I have watched the Texas system ignore documented abuse, silence my daughters voices, and use its power not to protect vulnerable children, but to shield the very structures that failed them.

— STEPHANIE

Caused the worst pain ever imaginable it's like the children are ripped out of our lives and we don't know if their dead or alive but definitely abused and should be allowed to be taken to a place of their mother's choosing to have their forensic interview's denied by their [...]

— DANA

The system has completely destroyed, my family. It has separated my children, and severed my God given right to mother be a mother to them. It has subjected us to a far more profound and evil level of the very abuse I was trying to protect my children from.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Alienated from my children completely including my entire family. Put me in embarrassing situations having to explain all the false accusations because they are public record. Taken all of my fatherly rights away when the accusers should have been punished.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Traumatized PTSD I had no visits pretty much the whole time the case was on false statement

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Above all the money, this has cost me the time I will never get back with my children.

— EDDIE

Overall, the system is rigged to allow attorneys and judges to prolong and continue proceedings until everyone runs out of money. Attorneys and judges make deals being closed doors that predetermine your case anyway. The whole system needs to be destroyed

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Furthered the abuse we had already escaped from, which caused extreme financial and mental strain; children's voices were suppressed

— ANONYMOUS PARENT



## 05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



*The Judicial System has failed my child and I! It has ripped a daughter away from her mother, all over false accusations and a greedy and vengeful ex!*

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Lied on everything I never had a chance to get child back and they terminated my rights even after finishing everything I was asked. CPS cases almost tripled In comanche county TX during 2017-2018 with almost no parental victory

— TERRI

My children lost access to their main emotional support and champion, even now they are punished for wanting to call me. My children are being taught how to stay silent about lies and abuse. I was defamed in my entire town, and lost everything.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed a mother-son relationship, empowered and protected parental alienation, caused trauma in mother and son, ignored facts and evidence.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I'm so thankful that the courts got it right for my children and me.

— RACHEL

Absolutely destroyed my motherhood and their childhood.

— LESLIE

Ignored a psych evaluation that said he's a danger to children and should never be alone with them. Caused Stockholm's syndrome in my children, deep trauma and alienation from my family and me.

— BOBBI

The system has made my children fatherless and destroyed our financial stability.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My ex file a TRO taking my kids from me immediately. I was scared and traumatized and ended up, settling with him having primary. My children's lives have been completely flipped up upside down, and he continues to do harm.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

## 05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



*Demolished my family. It took my kids from a loving mother and gave them to a monster.*

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My children were taken away from me unannounced, based solely on the word of my abuser & his wealthy parents which traumatized one of my 3 children severely. I have spent over 6-1/2 years defending myself & children from constant litigation, everything from an intervention filed [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Stolen my child from me and his grandparents and siblings.

— LAUREN

It destroyed it. My children's lives and hearts are destroyed.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has ruined me i barely know how to live anymore. It has allowed for my children to be used for profit in their pockets and I have to sit there and watch them be abused. I am lost soul

— DAKOTA

This system has caused such a distress my children will never get familiar time back from those that have passed.

— KRISTIN

The system has not protected my children from an abusive parent who also disclosed to a coparenting facilitator that he has been engaging in alienating parent activities like trying to win over the kids and talking bad about me and my spouse to the kids. Judge was only concerned [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ripped a newborn away from us causing loss of precious bonding time

— SARAH

This system has traumatized my family and dehumanized us to the core. We are missing our child so dearly

— SHIAERA

139 Texas parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 44 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

**06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — TEXAS**

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Texas families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

My case is an anomaly. It started out with CPS illegally taking my kids because I couldn't find my prescription medication that they knew my OBGYN prescribed me. 10 hrs after they took my babies I found my medicine bottle but they didn't care. My kids were put in foster care but THANK GOD it was w family. Even though they weren't in my kids lived prior to cps at least I knew my girls were safe w their paternal uncle & his wife. We went to mediation with my husband's brother & his wife with CPS leading it & agreed on an SPO. This was in 2018. From 2018-2023 we coparented pretty well & my babies were happy for the most part. Until Dec. 2023 when my brother in law & his wife literally tricked us/threatened us/pressured & coerced us into signing something that ended up being something completely different than what they said it was. They tricked us into signing our rights to visitation away. & since then they have turned our angels against us to the point where they no longer even acknowledge our existence. However, I just found out that not only did they trick us into signing our visitation rights away (we're still possessory conservators), I found that they committed extrinsic fraud, tampering w government records, notary fraud, & their attorney made some highly illegal moves as well. So, CPS is no longer involved & no longer the problem. It's solely between my husband & me against my brother in law & his wife who have erased us from our babies lives. But here's my quote on what our own family has done to us & our angel girls; THEY HAVE INTENTIONALLY & QUITE LITERALLY RUINED ALL 4 OF OUR LIVES BY RIPPING US AWAY FROM OUR DAUGHTERS WHEN THAT'S THE LAST THING MY BABIES

— ANONYMOUS PARENT (1/2)

WOULD'VE EVER WANTED. THEY'VE PUT HATE, RESENTMENT, & NEGATIVE THOUGHTS & EMOTIONS INTO 2 INNOCENT LITTLE GIRLS HEARTS & MINDS. THEY'VE FORCED THEM INTO A HARDCORE EMOTIONAL & PSYCHOLOGICAL HELL WHERE MY GIRLS ARE BEIN SILENCED. THEY'VE CAUSED MY OLDEST, ESPECIALLY. IRREPARABLE MENTAL HEALTH ISSUES & TRAUMA THAT SHE'S GONNA HAVE TO SPEND YEARS IF NOT FOREVER TRYING TO HEAL FROM. & AS FAR & ME & MY HUSBAND GOES; THEY HAVE CAUSED US TO HATE LIVING & BREATHING MOST THE TIME BECAUSE A WORLD WITHOUT MY BABIES IN IT IS A WORLD I DON'T WANT TO BE A PART OF. BUT WE'RE NOT THINKIN LIKE THAT NOW THAT WE'VE CAUGHT THEM & THEIR FRAUDULENT ACTIVITIES. WHICH I'M WORKIN ON GETTIN READY TO TAKE TO THE DA. THIS HAS 100% RUINED MY MARRIAGE TO THE POINT IT'S ALSO IRREPARABLE. THE WORST PART IS HOW BADLY & CONSTANTLY MY HEART PHYSICALLY ACHES & DROPS FROM MY CHEST EVERY TIME. I THINK OF THE PAIN & CONFUSION THAT MY BABIES ARE BEING FORCED TO FEEL.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT (2/2)

Ripped my family to shreds. Kids and mother traumatized. This is so much worse than being married to an abuser.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

**06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED**

The family court system in Wilbar County Texas has abused my children. They're alienated for me. My oldest hates me and thinks the grandmother told them that I abandoned them. IThe family court system in Wilbar County Texas has abused my children. Their alienated for me. My oldest hates me and thinks the grandmother told them that I abandoned them. I didn't want to be a mom because she would have the sheriff they were to block me from participating in anything so he never he half the time he didn't know I was there. They're working on my younger two now it's destroying my family. I've lost everything my my father strangled my 10-year-old and the judge and he worked together for years and years they're good friends and he called da we grand jury for impeding a child's breath with intended to kill. They have ruined my life. They've defended me. They've slanted me. They've destroyed my children. They're breaking my children mentally they're abusing my children and nobody nobody cares, and my children are native American Indian in the state of Texas, you have to follow the Indian child welfare act to a T and he refuses tore in the county where this happened and they've been investigating it for over a year and got it dismissed

— SHAWN

Family court fraudulent took my kids and placed them with the parent that they were initially removed from with CPS.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has destroyed me and my kids bond my family my peace of mind in my right to be a mom to my children

— ELNETTA

The family court system has caused even more trauma for my son and I, and places our abusers rights, over my child's safety. Over 6 years they have exhausted my family me, and my son, and all of our time, effort, and finances, while my son continues to be abused by his father and his affiliates. No end in sight. This man wants power and control and to win at all costs, to gain access to me and to hurt me. He doesn't care about our son. Our son begs not to have to go. I feel so stuck, and there's minimal to no help, nor end in sight. I rely on my faith in God, not trust in man. I'm using my student loans, and selling my blood plasma to pay my attorney. I have nothing left, and I cannot go pro se. Please get some domestic violence and coercive control awareness and training help here in Montgomery County Texas. Train these lawyers and judges. Start cracking down on abusers!

— GRACE

**06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED**

It has destroyed my life. They have ripped away the only joy in my life and for no reason than my ex wanted to look like the better parent!!

— LORI

The 328th family court in fort bend county TX has been a complete disaster for my family. Judge Monica Rawlins is a lousy Judge that separates families and doesn't review evidence submitted to the court. I have had to pay over \$50k to an attorney to fight a false TRO and false allegations that were allowed in this courtz and when I couldn't afford anymore, I became pro se. Still in the process of trying to get some visitation but this judge has a corrupt system and thinks she is above the law. Also the amicus (Danny Hoke) that was appointed by judge Rawlins, to my case, contributes to her election campaign and is not a neutral officer of the court. Who ever said that is lying. They are both lousy at their jobs. Hopefully she will lose this November 2026 election and not be able to do this to other families. Hopefully this help someone else who needs to be informed. It's all a pay to play system at its worst.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I lost any joy in my life at all. Everything a mother should be there for was ripped away. I have 2 sons that were married with children when this happened with my daughter so when they took her. I had nothing anymore. All over false accusations and a caseworker named Chrystal Gillette that lies about everything and everyone in this county. She shows up and immediately says she is recommend termination and Everytime I was given a drug test I passed until she gave them to me and I would fail only hers. She is the type of caseworker who sees the dollar signs not the best interest of children and the judge phil Robertson was the same way. Been trying for case records for years and nothing has been sent yet

— TERRI

Stolen my only child. Facilitated and assisted the abuser in continued abuse and neglect to myself and my child.

— HEATHER

**06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED**

The judge didn't listen to my children when he took them to his chambers and they told him the physical abuse they witnessed at the hand of their father he didn't listen to the things the kids had went through being mentally abused by him. He did not listen to the answers where I was able to ask questions and he admitting on the stand he had child abuse record from 2008 he served 8 years in prison for beating his step son he admitted he did on stand he admitted to being mentally and physically abusive towards me and the kids the judge wouldn't look my evidence nothing I was with my kids everyday while he went over the road as a truck driver my kids are scared of him they are loosing their hair because of stress no one will listen

— MIRANDA

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— BRANDI

It has destroyed me it has caused my children pain and suffering..my baby is so confused about everything

— DESTINY

Tortured us, stolen my children's youth and our family

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This system has destroyed my life, rendered me homeless, cost me well over \$20k and counting, and has crushed my son's heart and soul. I am still in the fight. I will try to hold out as long as possible. The family court system and my ex's attorney are evil incarnate and need to be stoped before more kids are harmed and traumatized.

— JACOB

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— M

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— DANA

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Stolen my child from me and his grandparents and siblings.

— LAUREN

It destroyed it. My children's lives and hearts are destroyed.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

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This system has caused such a distress my children will never get familiar time back from those that have passed.

— KRISTIN

The system has not protected my children from an abusive parent who also disclosed to a coparenting facilitator that he has been engaging in alienating parent activities like trying to win over the kids and talking bad about me and my spouse to the kids. Judge was only concerned with safety of our children's father's dog instead of our children and took his attorneys word for it that dog situation was taken care of. It wasn't.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ripped a newborn away from us causing loss of precious bonding time

— SARAH

**06** FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This system has traumatized my family and dehumanized us to the core. We are missing our child so dearly

— SHIAERA

Torn family apart and caused more trauma

— TIFFANY

The Masons tried to murder me and slandered my name to try and steal my children.

— SARAH

Decimated my high-profile career and severed ties with my children.

— DANIEL

Cost me freedom emotionally. I'm all my children know and I'm their security.

— ERIKA

This system has definitely destroyed my children mentally know they have to say with their mom by force. They cry to me about they don't know who is good or bad.

— KEITH

The family court system has destroyed a once happy and laughter filled home and replaced it with fear and anxiety.

— KAYSHA

Destroyed my relationship with my son who I fought so hard to protect. Now he thinks abuse is normal and is 100% indifferent to me. I sold everything to fight for him and he could care less. It's not his fault but our relationship was destroyed.

— LISA

**06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED**

The legal/court system has completely and utterly let down a parent that 150% should have the children. When a registered sex offender gets primary custody of a child, something is seriously wrong.

— MONIQUE

It destroyed my child's trust, and broke his heart. I could never stop fighting, no matter what it was costing me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

She is totally one sided and follows the attorney that she is best buds with that hands her most of her cases. She did not asses fairly at all

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Justice and Peace were designed to coincide. Paperwork is the warfare Truth has been hidden under.

— SUMMER

The Denton County 393 Court purposely and willfully put my child in repeated danger with a repeat offender of Domestic Violence. The judge has a pattern of punishing the protective parent and rewarding the neglectful abuser.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Judge Karl Hays' court failed to protect my children from a father with 10+ years of documented family violence, substance abuse issues even in front of the children, and untreated mental health issues. Our case had several previous protective orders, orders for substance abuse treatment orders, and mental health treatment orders. Despite this, Judge Hays refused to order any evaluation or treatment and rather ordered reunification therapy.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

**06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED**

Took my child away with ZERO evidence or hearing then postponed the ex parte hearing for another 3 weeks due to “Employee Appreciation Day”

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This has cost me money, my health, my children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Absolutely destroyed it. There was physical evidence collected by a doctor several teachers, CID therapist, and yet she was still placed in his hands after brutal raping. Use my story, let's do a pod cast but help me stay safe too

— R.

contemplated suicide for first time, memory loss, deep depression, and lost a lot of money

— NORBERTO

Judge Rawlins has granted my ex husband full custody and given me SPO without exemptions to significantly reduce my time with my 3 children and won't even allow me to eat lunch with them at school. She took the false testimony given by the Amicus Cindy Aguirre without any evidence of harm/neglect to my children and no reason to reduce my custody.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has annihilated my confidence in our justice system. It has left my child and myself homeless and penniless and they did not care. The worst part is seeing how many more victims they have made as well as myself. Jason Price was the husband that i loved, but he assaulted me, betrayed me and lied repeatedly and these corrupt actors protected him. Law enforcement also lied — the Ovilla PD literally wrote falsehoods in the police report. I have physical injuries as well that have never been treated and are a constant source of excruciating pain.

— REBECCA

**06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED**

Its destroyed our kids, my relationship with them and ruined their childhoods. Plus mental health issues they're now experiencing as a result of being suddenly cut off from their primary, only, caregiver

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The state medically kidnapped my child. I found all of the Medicaid fraud and spoke out and I'm being retaliated against. Even with all of the evidence, the judge still gave my ex sole custody.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Removing kids for 9 days and for kids to be involved in domestic violence again being theater and hurt

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This process has left me feeling silenced and overwhelmed, forcing me to fight alone for my child's stability while our lives have been disrupted by delays, false accusations, and a lack of fairness in being heard.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Punished my children and me for no crime committed at a cost of time that can't be calculated

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has failed me as a loving caring dedicated mother and survivor of marital abuse. Losing children as a mother is the new scarlet letter. We are never left the same, the emotional and psychological damage is insurmountable and society is very unforgiving towards us. The system should be designed for the best interest of the child not to fund this flawed system of courts to rob families.

— CLAUDIA

**06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED**

Traumatized, bankrupted, lost opportunities, childhood, etc

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have caused a tremendous amount of set backs for me an my family financial, emotional , mental ect . Where is our pursuit of happiness

— TIFFANY

Trying to take my rights and have my 3 boys adopted

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Took 7 months of normal time with my baby, due to false allegations that led to supervised visits and inability to keep breastfeeding. My 2 week old infant was handed to the father in court even though he's not listed on birth certificate. I lost child support I'd been getting for 4 years after my ex husband used the allegations to file a custody modification, and "won" because I didn't have an attorney at the time since I had to spend money on a criminal attorney.

— KATELYN

Created choas and un safe position for my children while ignoring evidence

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court system has destroyed my life and the relationship I had with my three young Daughters. They are quickly joining the fatherless home statistics.

— HARRY

The GAL on my case made numerous false accusations about me on the stand and convinced the judge to put me on supervised visitation. The GALs name is Auburne Gallagher and you can find her all over TikTok and YouTube showcasing just how hostile and violent she really is as a person. She's disgusting.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

**06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED**

They defamed me, beat me down as a mother, persecuted me for my faith, twisted my words and painted the worst picture of me made of biased, false, religious discrimination and bias foster placement. They refused to help my son with his sexual behaviors. I was discriminated for a mis-diagnosis I recieved when I was a teenager. They denied me accommodations and the support me and my son needed. They came after my marriage. Took my son from me, caused him emotional harm and I dealt with parental alienation. They shattered my heart and the relationship I had with my son. They turned my family against me and the entire court. They falsified documents. The system destroyed instead of reunification.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Have taken my get away from me without real reason

— TRINITY

Just when I thought I could get my life back, I met a man as sick as my ex-husband and the entire system has taken everything I own, and separated me from everyone I hold dear! They're still coming after me because I won't remain silent until I get my retirement back and my kids back in my life!

— THERESA (STORMY)

Traumatized me and my family

— SANDRA

Nothing. I have lost my daughter and I feel she doesn't know me anymore .

— ELIZABETH

The system is corrupt. The judges and lawyers are only operating within the corrupt system. Systemic change is required. The system turned me into an activist.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Delay me seeing my child grow up and spending time with my little girl.

— ALICIA



**06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED**

Traumatized all of us, son will never fully recover and even has to go to a special school

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They've emotionally and mentally damaged my children and myself along with physically making us ill due to they lack of integrity and accountability. They allowed domestic violence to be turned into financially abuse while filling their own pockets. Family Court is the liars court who favor the highest bidder.

— NICOLE

The system allows the abuse to continue even after you thought you finally escaped your abuser. I will stand for this injustice no more.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have completely taken advantage of mothers who can't afford to fight in court and stripped them of their children's lives because their father has the money to pay off everyone.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My children were happy thriving free strong brave creative. They are suffering. Lost identity. Troubled. Unhappy. Lost the light in their eyes. Oldest self loathing. Youngest thinks it's cool to be angry and mean.

— JESSICA

A 6 year old has been diagnosed with PTSD and severe trauma, due to Karl hays not paying attention or acting in the best interest of the CHILD. Our family has been broken for 5.5 years.

— GREGORY

We are out of money and trying to find a second jobs.No further ahead than when we started 3 years ago. And children without their Mom...so heartbreaking ❤️ God help us 🙏

— DEBBIE

**06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED**

Kidnapped my beloved son from me and from his siblings.

— MARISOL

This system in lubbock county has helped alienate my daughter from me and left me with nothing but severe anxiety and a broken heart.

— KAYSHA

The system has leaned heavily toward only relying on its own agencies and has denied and or refused to speak or hear my side while my attorney being present.

— JAYRO

Broke my family and separated siblings

— SHARK MOM

Caused immense mental distress for me and my two young daughters, rendered me homeless and emotionally unstable.

— GREG

A parent who almost lost her life because I really thought they were in the right and I thought I was a bad mother.

— LORENA

Parent child estrangement through parental alienation starting in 2004 until now.

— BRANDYE

The system has damaged the relationship my girls once had over allegations of a drug addict.

— KRISTI

**06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED**

Due to delayed hearings, the abuse of the uccjea, and negotiations not being timely handled, I was forced to settle without addressing the years worth of interference.

— BILL

Caused estrangement grandparents brother sister , father mother children

— TONYA

I proved the abuse, alcoholism, drug addiction and untreated mental illnesses. He has been manipulating our son since the day he moved out. Telling our son I was liar, thief and whore. Broke our great bond. He won't allow him to go to counseling. They proved our son had a 68 in math on me. The judge gave him primary. The child I solely took care of for 13 years with zero help I get to see every 1,3,5 weekends.

— CRYSTAL

My experience within the family court system was nothing short of a living nightmare. During a global pandemic, my children were taken from me, and my parental rights were suspended “until further order of the court.” I felt completely alone, with nowhere to turn, and was forced to cease all communication with my children this lasted for almost 2 years. The emotional toll including the stress, anxiety, and anguish has had lasting effects that I continue to carry with me to this day. I've lost years that I will never get back. I can't help but think, “This should have never happened. We didn't deserve this.” When I pictured raising my family, this is not how I envisioned it. Now, after an long drawn out battle I only see my children every other weekend, and it often feels like I'm watching someone else raise them. It is truly heartbreaking.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

10 years later and still rebuilding my life. I loathe my business and career entirely. I truly understand a midlife crisis' meaning now.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Sad that this is allowed to happen time and time again- no accountability for the family court system

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

**06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED**

The system allowed for my ex wife to have an affair with my friend with no way to defend myself. They allowed me to be harassed and assaulted by her and her affair partner. I lost everything. She also destroyed my name and ruined so many of my relationships where we live. Also she ruined my relationships with her family. My son was destroyed and became sexually active at her house instantly when she moved in with him. I lost custody time on top of being punished for everything that she has done.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My son has changed completely and is scared everyday with his abuser. It's only going to get worse now that he has control of what he does. My son thinks I'm punishing him and I can't explain to him it's nothing he did I promise.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Hundreds of cases like mine here

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

She empowered my ex that he can weaponize court and threaten me with it to do anything outside of our decree agreement.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

These demons have tried to destroy my family but God.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ripped us apart and made life a living hell. My poor babies are struggling and gone through so much because the justice system is so crooked. But I wont give up.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has broken my family. It is broken my spirit. Almost led me to suicide

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

**06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED**

My daughter was taken out of my arms by a police officer that was later imprisoned for selling drugs and tampering with evidence. Not to mention the then foster parent that have since adopted my children was in jail on an injury to a child charge. WTF??

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I no longer believe in the court system and justice. This system that is supposed to be “in the best interest” of children is actively abusing them by incentivizing the parent willing to lie and manipulate.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I would say the family court system is a joke, but it is not funny. I haven't seen my daughter in 2.5 years and I am homeless and over \$300,000 in debt. I was defrauded out of my home and life savings worth over \$5 million at age 55.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has violated every single one of my basic rights as a citizen, a parent, a mother as well as causing irreparable damage to me, My children, our relationship and our trust. The mental, emotional and physical toll that this has taken on me and my children will forever be scared and burned into us, I don't know if we can ever come back or recover from this.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system took what little family I had which was my son and ripped him away from me it didn't even have the courtesy to do it in front of me. They chose to why and keep me away from the courthouse.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Totally separated me from my son. I wouldn't even know him if I saw him today. Horrible

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has broke our family up entirely and the mother is going back to prison

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

**06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED**

It has stolen their mom when they needed me the most. They had to learn to be strong and survive at their dads. All dad wanted was no child support at all costs. I will never get that time back with them

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Taken my son and supervised visits. Because me and my mom finally told my son the truth regarding my ex criminal history and abuse. Had my son record conversation with out us consenting tyen used in court.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

After my ex planned my murder and stalked me and his step daughter, the system was weaponized to perpetuate abuse. My exes and their counsel joined forces, leading to me attempting suiced to avoid facing him in court.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They gave my abusive ex full control. I have been completely pushed out, just like he's always wanted. I fought hard for years to protect her and myself and it felt like a slap in my face when the judge brushed off his domestic violence charge.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court system is a joke!! It abuses those that have already been through enough. Emotional abuse, gaslighting, negligence, financial abuse, child trafficking, SLAVERY, slander, defamation of character the list goes on and on!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system helps the parent who can afford it. Whoever loves the children the most is the one who suffers and loses precious time with them. It is a broken, unfair, unbalanced system.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ruined my father daughter relationship

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

**06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED**

I had an attorney, then ran out money. Went pro se -did well. Then found OC outside my home hiding-stalking-waiting-watching. I then had to hire an attorney as I was afraid for my life due to threats previously. Attorney came into the case, then ran out of money. Went pro se again until final and attorney came back onto the case.

— MADDY

Guilty until proven innocent, attempted complete family destruction via felony level allegations.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They left Navy in the care of a stranger that got possession of baby without consent for false allegations without seeing our evidence. They made us miss all the firsts!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

we have nothing to celebrate any more, you broke us, and we didn't deserve this.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Taken away time and money made rulings with out me present - denied my evidence and request for justly trial

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My children have been living without a parent or siblings, my older child has low self esteem, emotional disorder, and suicidal thoughts, she has been institutionalized in mental health facility, my middle son is confused and angry with me being groomed to think I don't love him and a bad person, I don't know anything about my youngest. I have been in and out of jail on numerous set ups paying a lot in bonds and taking on a terrible background. My business is almost at a complete vault and I struggle to make enough money to survive due to my record.

— TIFFANI

**06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED**

The people who are responsible for making major decisions in the lives of people they do not know should be educated and trained on narcissistic and manipulative behavior. Being able to make decisions like that, that do not affect their lives the second they walk out the door should require a hell of a lot more than just words told by a vengeful ex or someone who knows how to use a system to abuse the other parent.

— JESSICA

The Brazos County court system has left my family deeply fractured after I was ordered with only 24 hours' notice to relocate my four children to the same town as their father, forcing immediate school changes, housing decisions, and major financial disruption. I was told the alternative was incarceration and that my children would be placed in their father's sole custody. This has had a lasting impact on my family's stability and well-being.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Completely took the side of the mother without giving me a chance to give my side of the story. Mother has lied on multiple affidavits and under oath in court multiple times.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Wife alleged allegations of assault with a weapon against her husband. All false, all lies. She injured herself and claimed he did it. She has a history of mental issues and psych hospital stays. Husband has NO history of violence, arrests or trouble. Ever. Yet he is considered guilty until proven innocent. This is dragging on - he has not been able to see or talk to his child in over 4 months. In the meantime, child lives with mom who is not emotionally stable. A case like this needs to be expedited for the child's sake (7 years old)

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Is so far the court is attempting to force services and other requirements on me despite any request for service or citation of the original petition which quantifies to a lack of jurisdiction and violation of due process. Despite this they are attempting to move forward with the case.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT



**06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED**

“I did everything right — clean tests, stable home, completed services — and still had my child taken and my role reduced to a visitor, costing me thousands of dollars and irreplaceable time during the most important stage of her life.”

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have completely ignored my evidence and teachers testimonies and a principal testimony, ignored MHMR records didn't force my subpoena for the skills teacher that seen my son and did parenting class with me. Filed a Writ of attachment judge signed it then when I appeared in court to argue my ex had already the very same day we had gotten out of court the time before refused my visit and he did nothing but threaten to throw me in jail

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Gave my daughter bad anxiety and both are scared of their dad so they beg me not to reopen the case they dont want him mad. I've lost alot of money and time with my children and 3 years worth of Christmas. All the money I was owed for not getting the house i remodel on my own with my credit cards I got after the divorce I had to pay. And im still paying for his credit card and im owed spousal support of 1500 he refuses to pay.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

139 full approved Texas comments are included in this appendix.

## 07 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

### WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a national, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Texas report comes from Texas respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Texas — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

### WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 192 Texas families reporting here are not the universe of Texas families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. We flag outliers and report medians when means are distorted (see page 3, note 1). The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

### METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – May 2026 through [standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey](https://standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey). Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

When a respondent's financial entry differs from the population by more than three standard deviations, the mean is suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte-Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

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### ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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